

01 / WHY I BUILT IT

Working in support, I kept thinking about beginners.

I use Microsoft Learn a lot in my work.

The services are well explained.
But if you're new to cloud, why do you
need them together?



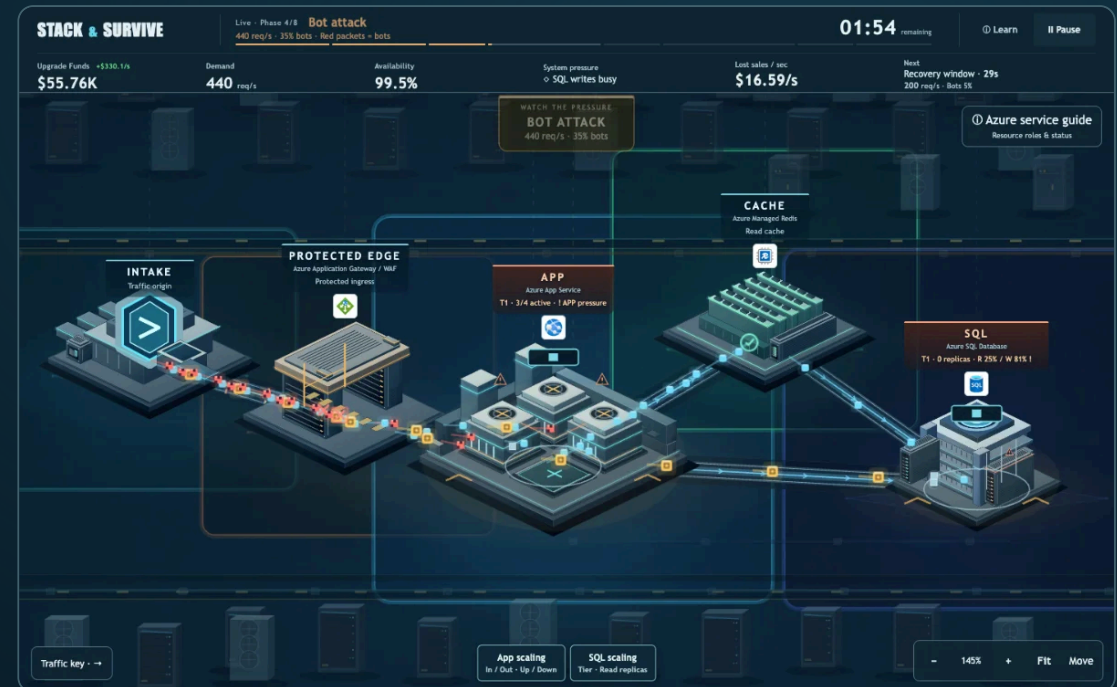
That led me to build Stack & Survive. Local captures: a6f6956 · rules 0.4.

02 / SO I MADE A GAME

Instead of explaining it, let people run it.

You decide when to add App capacity,
Cache and Edge.

React too late, and customer requests fail.
You lose sales in the game.



You add the facilities and see what changes.

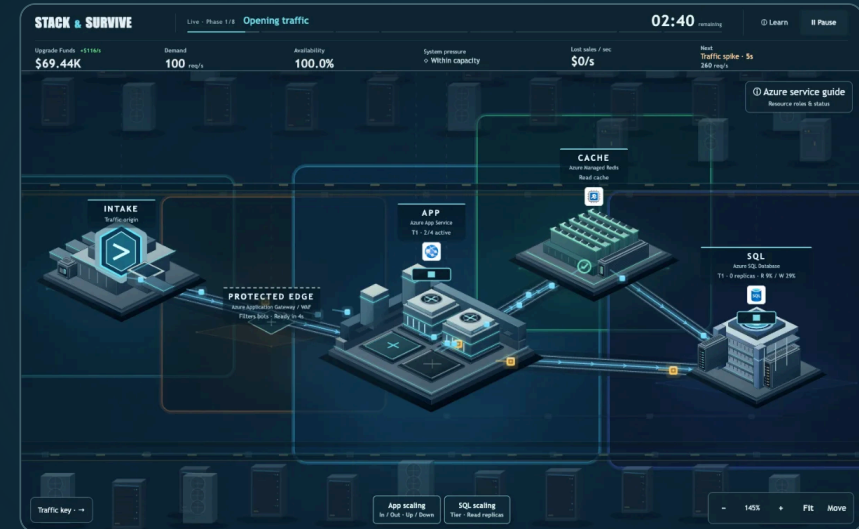
03 / BLACK FRIDAY

Get through 180 seconds of Black Friday.

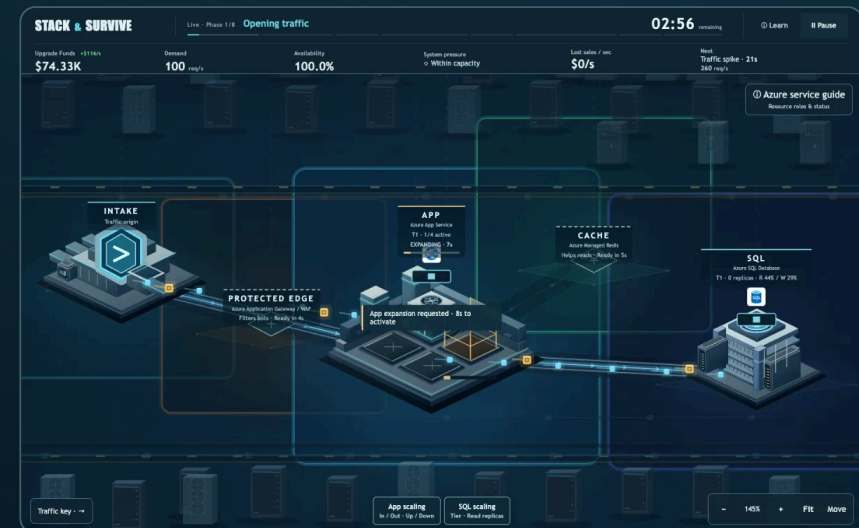
- Start: 100 req/s
- Traffic spikes, then bots arrive
- Later: 560 req/s • 40% bots
- Final 20 seconds: 600 req/s • 45% bots

Eight phases, with recovery windows.
Build before the next wave arrives.

Game money is not actual Azure pricing.



Watch the next-wave warning.



Under construction ≠ active capacity

You decide what to add first.

App

More throughput · takes 8 seconds to activate

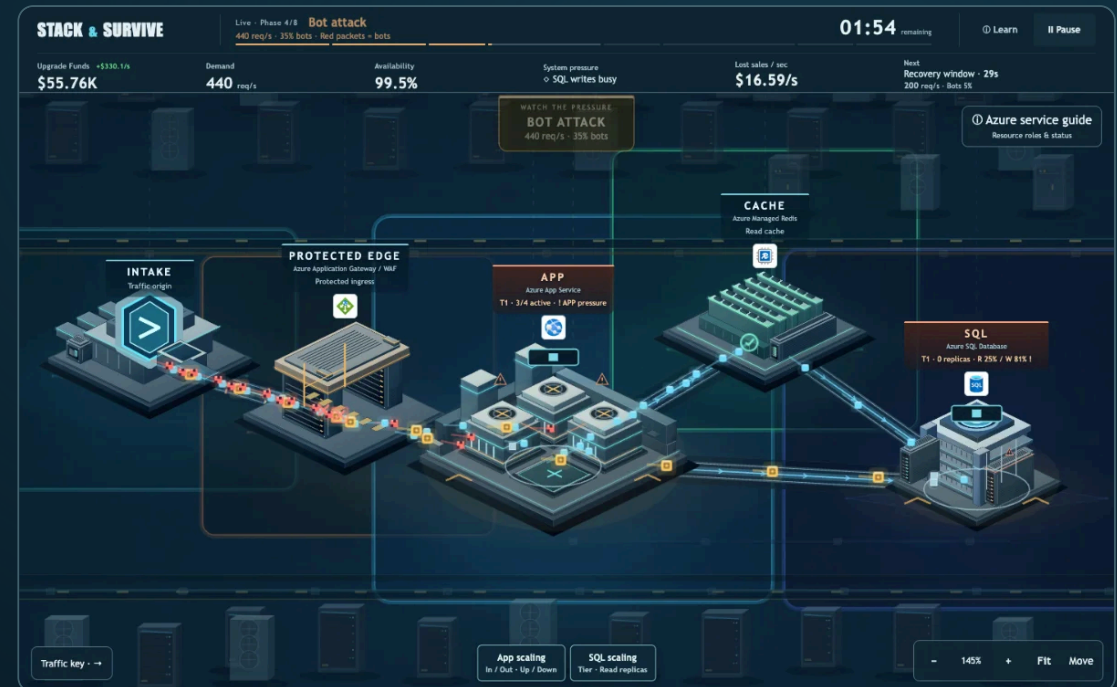
Cache

Helps eligible reads · order writes still go to SQL

Protected Edge

Blocks bots · can also reject legitimate customers

Running costs matter. More isn't always better.



Adding App capacity can leave SQL as the next bottleneck.

05 / CHECK THE RESULT, TRY AGAIN

See how your run went.

Availability · lost sales · cost · score

Next time, expand App earlier.

Or change the order of Cache and Edge.

Meet the objective to join the leaderboard.

Objectives: survive 180s → 99% availability → 99.9%



Automated local run · a6f6956 / rules 0.4 · not a human or public verified entry.

06 / HOW I'D LIKE PEOPLE TO USE IT

Try it first. Then look up what puzzled you.

I hope reading Microsoft Learn feels
more concrete after running this setup.

We still need user testing to find out whether it helps.

AFTER ADDING CACHE

Why didn't the writes change?

Eligible reads and order writes take different paths.



AFTER EXPANDING APP

Why is SQL busy now?

Check which layer is limiting the system.



WHEN YOU WANT TO KNOW MORE

Go back to Microsoft Learn.

Check how the real services work and how to configure them.

07 / THANK YOU

I wanted to make getting started a little easier.

Stack & Survive

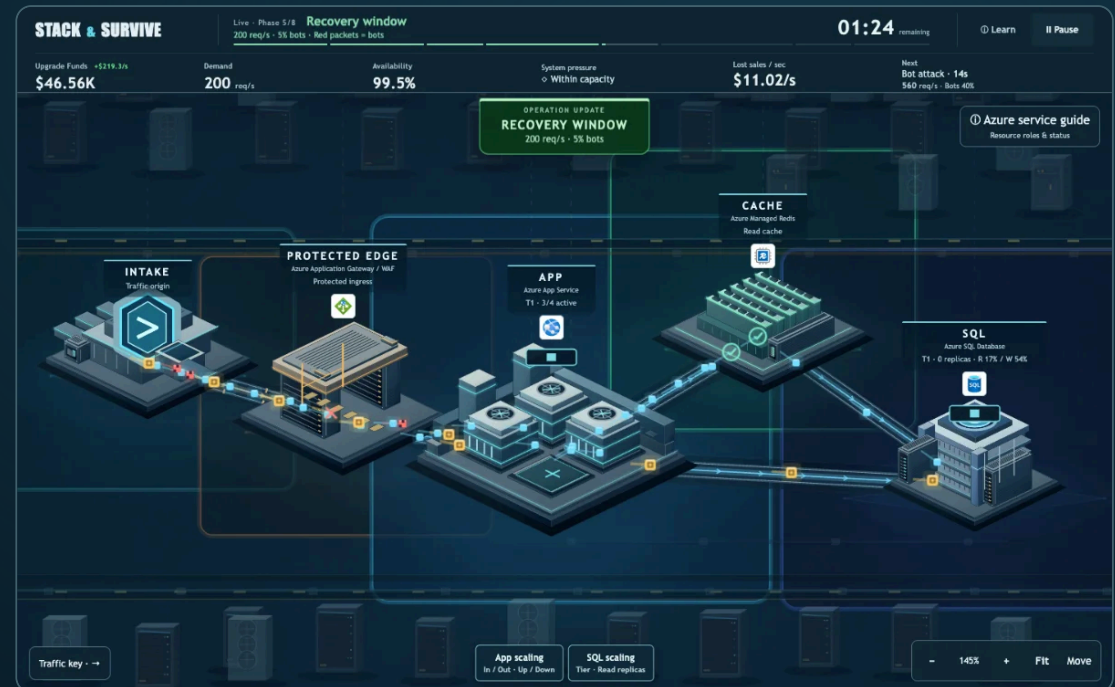
Try running App, Cache and Edge through Black Friday.

Build. Scale. Keep the business flowing.

Same workload. Different architectures. Different outcomes.

[Play the game ↗](#)

yeongseon.github.io/stack-and-survive/



Give it a run and see what you'd change.